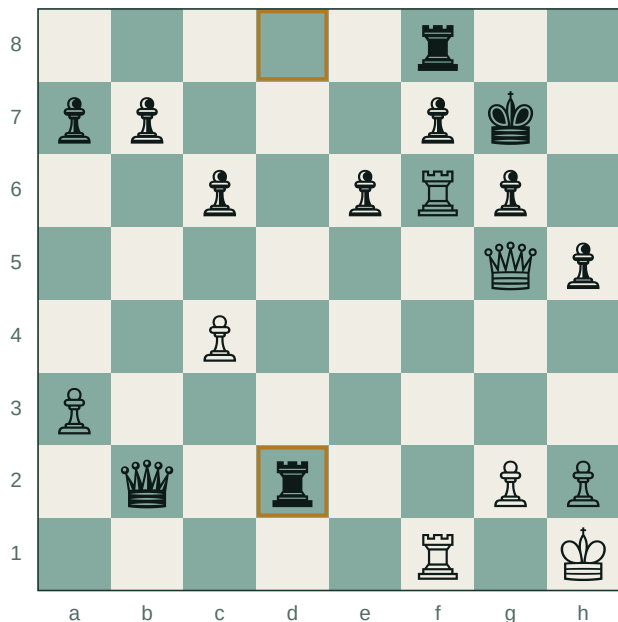


Clearance tactics: White, move 32

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 31...Rd2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

32. Rxg6+ fxg6 33. Qe7+ Kh6 34. Qxf8+ Qg7 35. Qf4+ Kh7 36. Qxd2

32.Rxg6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on g6. Recorded reply: **32...fxg6**.

33.Qe7+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From e7 it attacks king on g7 and rook on f8. Recorded reply: **33...Kh6**.

34.Qxf8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on f8. Recorded reply: **34...Qg7**.

35.Qf4+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From f4 it attacks king on h6 and rook on d2. Recorded reply: **35...Kh7**.

36.Qxd2 The queen captures the rook on d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g7. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.